

James "Courtney" Perigo

EXPERT DATA SCIENCE LEADER DRIVING INNOVATION FOR BUSINESS SUCCESS

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PROFILE

Data Science Executive with nearly 20 years of experience bridging advanced analytics and business strategy. Expert in leading high-performing teams to deploy scalable ML solutions, from hierarchical Bayesian media mix platforms to agentic AI workflows. Combines a rigorous academic foundation in Bayesian and frequentist inference with a practical focus on driving digital transformation and measurable ROI.

SKILLS

Expert in Applied Data Science, Data Engineering, AI & Machine Learning Deployment. Proficient in Business Intelligence Architecture and Cloud Infrastructure. Advanced programming skills in Python, R, SQL, Go, and JavaScript. Committed to servant leadership, fostering team growth and cross-functional collaboration.

EXPERIENCE

SVP, Director of Data Science and Analytics

Empower Ocean Media | 2025 – present | Chicago, IL

- Lead Empower's data science and analytics practice, a five-person team of two data scientists, two data engineers, and an ML Ops engineer, and provide technical vision and mentorship for the agency's broader 15+ person analytics organization. Own marketing mix modeling, attribution, and measurement for enterprise clients including Whataburger, JD Sports, PetSmart, and Sprouts Farmers Market.
- Built a production hierarchical Bayesian marketing mix modeling platform that guides more than \$220 million in annual media investment across 50+ markets. Versioned model releases, automated refresh pipelines, and automated quality gates replaced static quarterly studies with continuously updated reads.
- Developed modeling capabilities beyond the standard open-source toolset, including dynamic intercepts for new and expanding markets and geo-level informed priors. The agency retained this work as proprietary IP.
- Launched a scenario-planning service that lets planning teams run self-service budget optimization on model outputs.
- Created an agentic AI operating practice for the team: version-controlled knowledge systems that AI agents read, maintain, and draft from, with human review at every step. The practice speeds up weekly executive reporting, model documentation, and week-to-week delivery continuity.
- Present model findings directly to client executive teams and brief the agency CEO and leadership weekly. Recommendations have informed seven-figure media reallocations, an account defense win, and new business pitches.

Founder & Owner

Empire Sports Analytics | 2022 – present | Chicago, IL

- Concurrent venture. Own the complete business life cycle for a subscription sports analytics product: P&L, financing, product roadmap, marketing, and customer relationships.

SVP, Executive Director of Data Sciences

Cramer-Krasselt | 2018 – 2025 | Chicago, IL

- Led a 15+ person analytics organization across three offices. Realigned the team and modernized the tech stack around agile ways of working, which sped the agency's digital transformation roadmap and unified data intelligence across finance, operations, and delivery.
- Launched a curve-fit attribution microservice adopted by 8 enterprise clients. It added \$5M in annual recurring revenue and won a 2023 Drum Digital Advertising Award.
- Led a turnaround in 2018 that expanded agency billable rates by 300%.

VP, Director of Decision Sciences

Publicis, Moxie | 2014 – 2018 | Atlanta, GA

- Recruited and developed a 15+ person analytics and data science organization across two offices supporting eBay, Kohl's, and Verizon Wireless.
- Engineered a real-time Hidden Markov Model that scores millions of daily impressions to identify each Verizon prospect's funnel stage and improve audience targeting.
- Won the DMA Golden Echo Award for Best Use of Data.

Director, Analytics

Triad Retail Media, Wal-Mart | 2012 – 2014 | Tampa, FL

- Built a PostgreSQL data warehouse and Tableau self-service dashboards that cut sales report turnaround from 3 days to on-demand.
- Co-developed an omnichannel attribution engine with @WalmartLabs that linked credit card transactions to shopper marketing touchpoints and gave CPG clients like P&G and Pepsi SKU-level ROI on retail media.

Market Research Manager, Mobile Healthcare Solutions

Sage Software | 2010 – 2012 | Tampa, FL

- Authored the product roadmap for the company's first mobile EHR for ambulatory practices, grounded in provider surveys, conjoint analysis, and price elasticity studies.
- Managed the feature backlog so development focused on the capabilities research showed users valued, which shortened time to MVP.
- Partnered with Finance on profitability modeling and a multi-year business plan covering target margins, investment phasing, and the go-to-market path to break-even.

Manager, Analytics

Triad Retail Media, Wal-Mart | 2009 – 2010 | Tampa, FL

- Built the business intelligence processes for the start-up and helped the sales team reach \$200 million in annual billings.

Sr. Marketing Analyst

Media General, The Tampa Tribune | 2005 – 2009 | Tampa, FL

- Conducted statistical analysis and built data visualizations for the news and sales teams, with an emphasis on geographic information systems and mapping.

Media Planner, Buyer

Doner Advertising, FKQ Advertising | 2003 – 2005 | Tampa, FL

EDUCATION

- **Northwestern University**, MS, Data Science | 2020 – 2022
- **University of South Florida**, MBA, Finance & Marketing | 2007 – 2009
- **University of South Florida**, BA, Advertising | 1998 – 2003

PUBLICATIONS AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

- **"Get More Out of Your Data with Analytics Microservices"**, Towards Data Science, 2022. <https://towardsdatascience.com/get-more-out-of-your-data-with-analytics-microservices-9a5a34a3ad2f>
- **"Risk Assessment of Daily Fantasy Baseball Games Using Monte Carlo Analysis"**, HackerNoon and MLearning.ai, 2022. <https://hackernoon.com/using-monte-carlo-simulation-to-determine-why-you-wont-win-daily-fantasy-baseball-games>